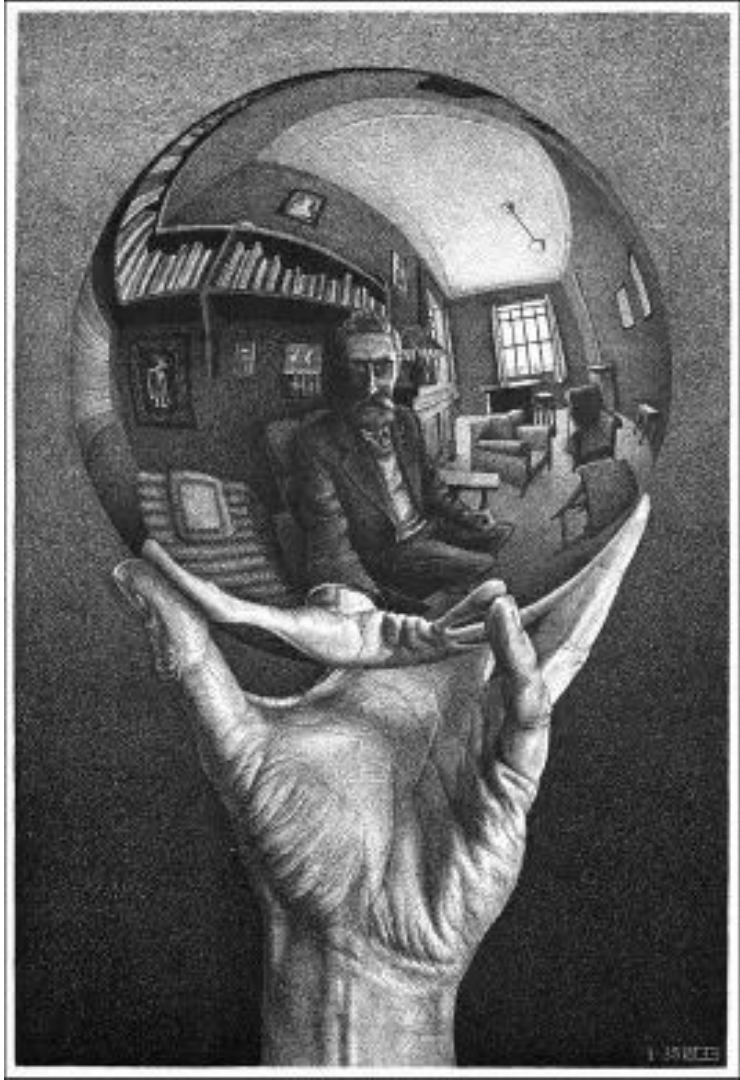
An architectural Visualization of the optical Illusions by MC Escher

Teague Roark

Reality-Warping Artwork

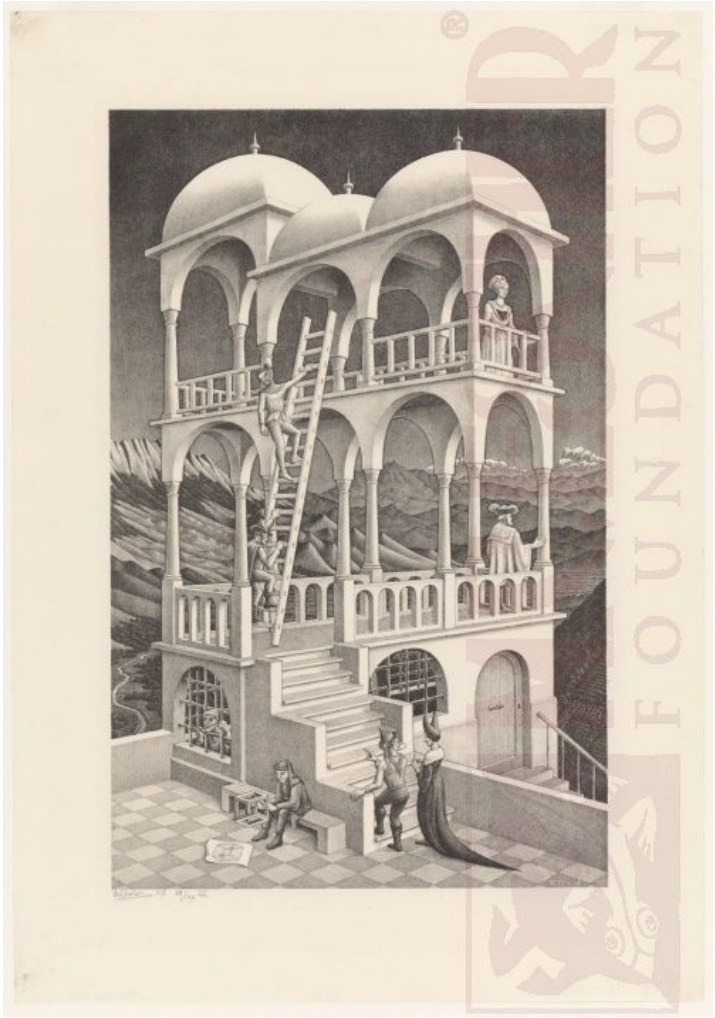
Maurits Cornelis Escher (1898-1972) was a **Dutch graphic artist** known for his intricate and often surreal prints that combine **mathematical concepts** with realistic techniques. His work is characterized by **impossible constructions**, **tessellations**, and **transformations**, often exploring themes of **infinity**, **reflection**, and **symmetry**.



Relativity
July 1953
Lithograph



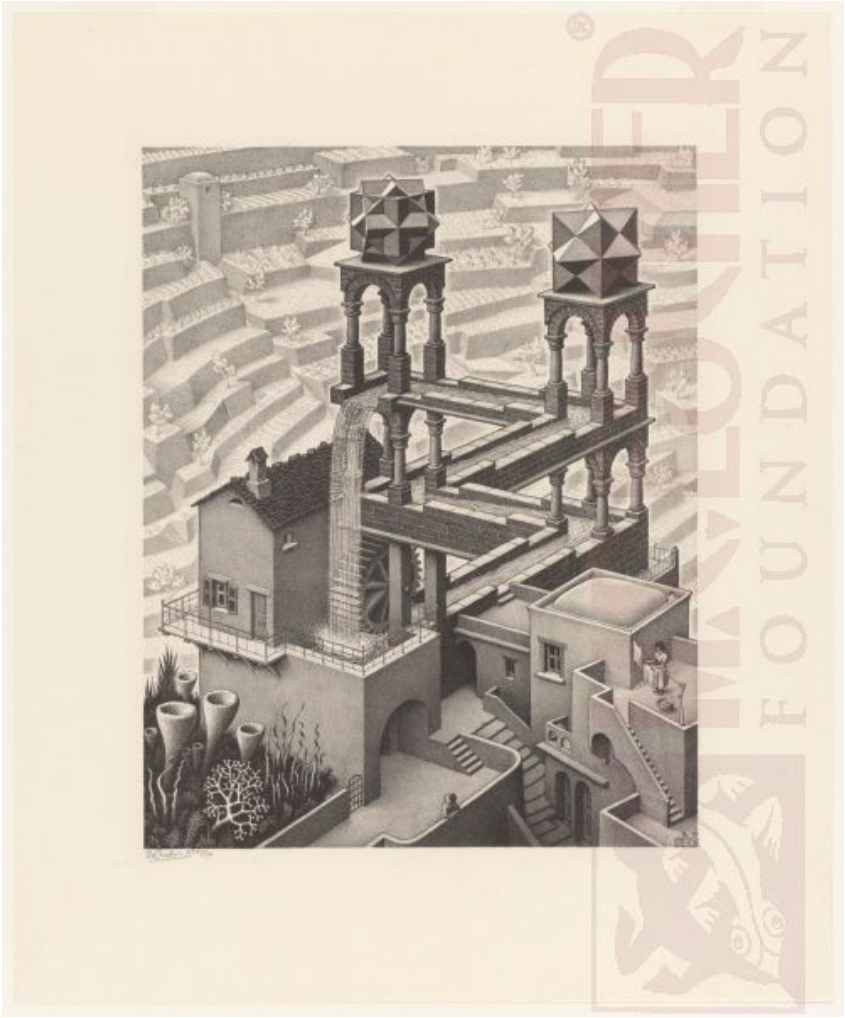
Belvedere
May 1958
Lithograph



Ascending + Descending
March 1960
Lithograph



Waterfall
October 1961
Lithograph



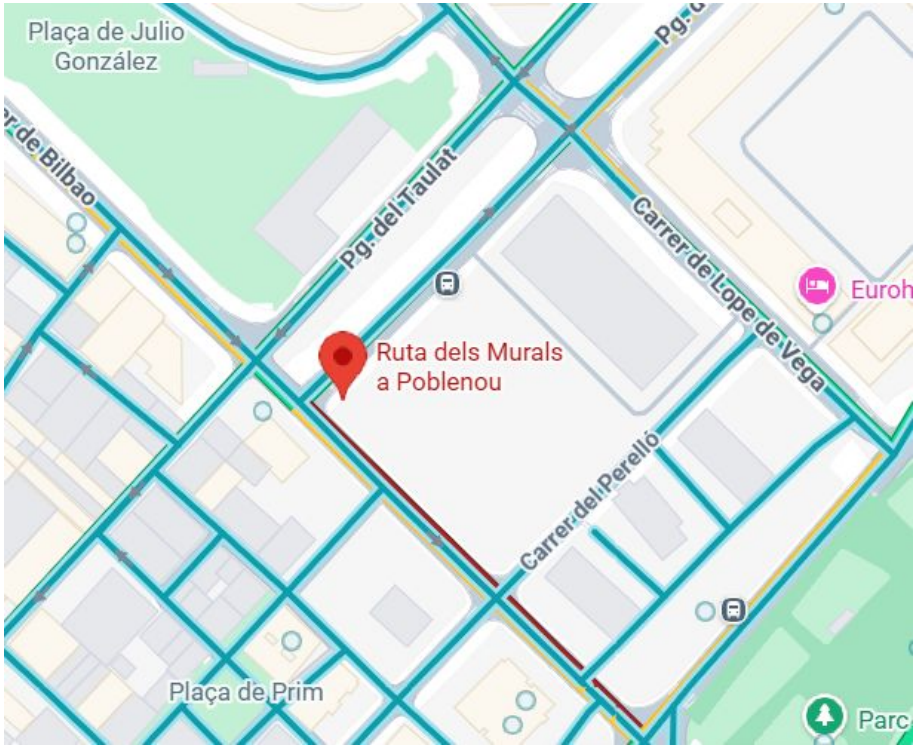
Site Context

Poblenou: Former industrial district

Ruta dels Murals: Street art presence.

Cerdà Grid Structure: Wide streets, chamfered corners, and visibility from multiple directions.

Mixed-Use Activity: Residential + offices + cafés for steady pedestrian movement all day.

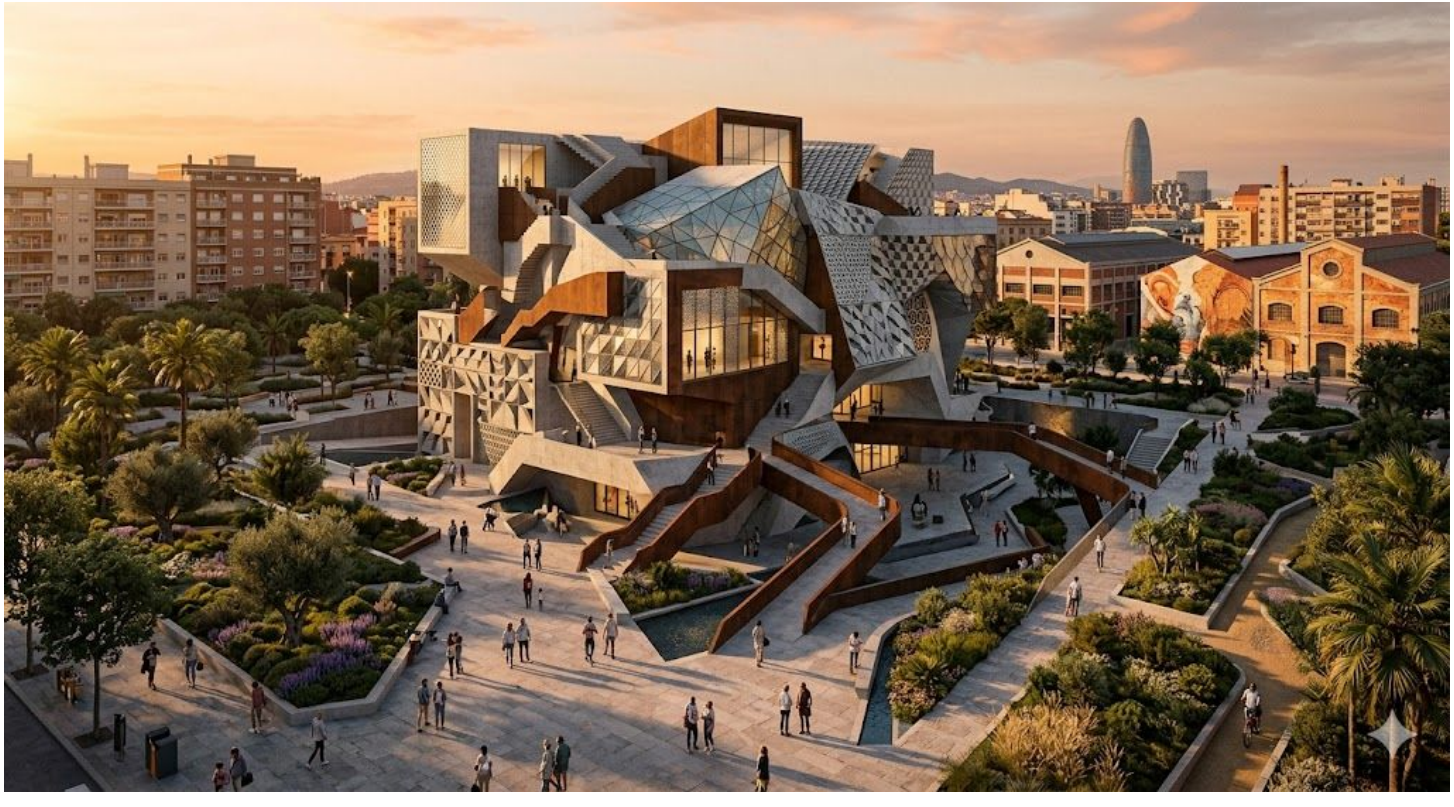


Artist Concept Image



Conceptual architectural mood image inspired by the artistic themes of MC Escher, abstract spatial interpretation of their work translated into architecture, textures, color palette and light inspired by their artwork, atmospheric gallery environment, poetic architecture, contemporary museum design language, minimal but expressive forms, Barcelona Mediterranean atmosphere, high quality architectural visualization, cinematic lighting.

EXTERIOR RENDER – PRIMARY HERO VIEW



Contemporary art gallery building inspired by the work of MC Escher, located in Poblenou Barcelona near Ruta dels Murals, bold sculptural architecture reflecting the artist's themes and forms, public plaza and urban park surrounding the building, people walking and interacting with the space, Mediterranean vegetation, dynamic facade materials inspired by the artist's artwork, Barcelona urban context, sunset golden hour lighting, cinematic architectural rendering, high quality architectural visualization, realistic materials.

EXTERIOR RENDER – PARK + BUILDING RELATIONSHIP



Public park landscape integrated with contemporary art gallery inspired by MC Escher, architecture opening into a green urban park, pathways and circulation flowing toward the building, Mediterranean plants and trees, sculptural landscape features inspired by the artist's work, people relaxing, biking, and walking, urban Barcelona neighborhood context, bright daylight, aerial perspective slightly above eye level, professional architectural visualization.

EXTERIOR RENDER – STREET LEVEL VIEW



Street level perspective of contemporary art gallery inspired by MC Escher, located in Poblenou Barcelona, expressive facade with artistic influence from the artist's work, pedestrians approaching the entrance, bike lanes and public plaza, Mediterranean light and shadows, textured facade materials, urban Barcelona atmosphere, cinematic architecture render, realistic materials, human scale figures.

EXTERIOR RENDER – NIGHT VIEW



Night architectural rendering of contemporary art gallery inspired by MC Escher, glowing interior light revealing gallery spaces through glass facade, public park illuminated with soft landscape lighting, people gathering outside, dramatic architecture lighting, Barcelona night atmosphere, cinematic lighting, high quality architectural visualization.

INTERIOR RENDER – MAIN GALLERY SPACE



Large contemporary art gallery interior inspired by MC Escher, dramatic natural lighting from skylights, minimal gallery walls displaying artwork, spatial experience reflecting the artist’s themes, clean concrete or stone floors, tall ceilings, visitors interacting with art, calm museum atmosphere, professional architectural visualization, cinematic lighting.

INTERIOR RENDER – TRANSITION SPACE / ATRIUM



Museum atrium interior space inspired by MC Escher, sculptural staircase and open circulation space, vertical light shafts and skylights, spatial drama and contrast between light and shadow, contemporary museum architecture, visitors moving through space, Barcelona Mediterranean light, high quality architectural rendering.

INTERIOR RENDER – SMALL INTIMATE GALLERY



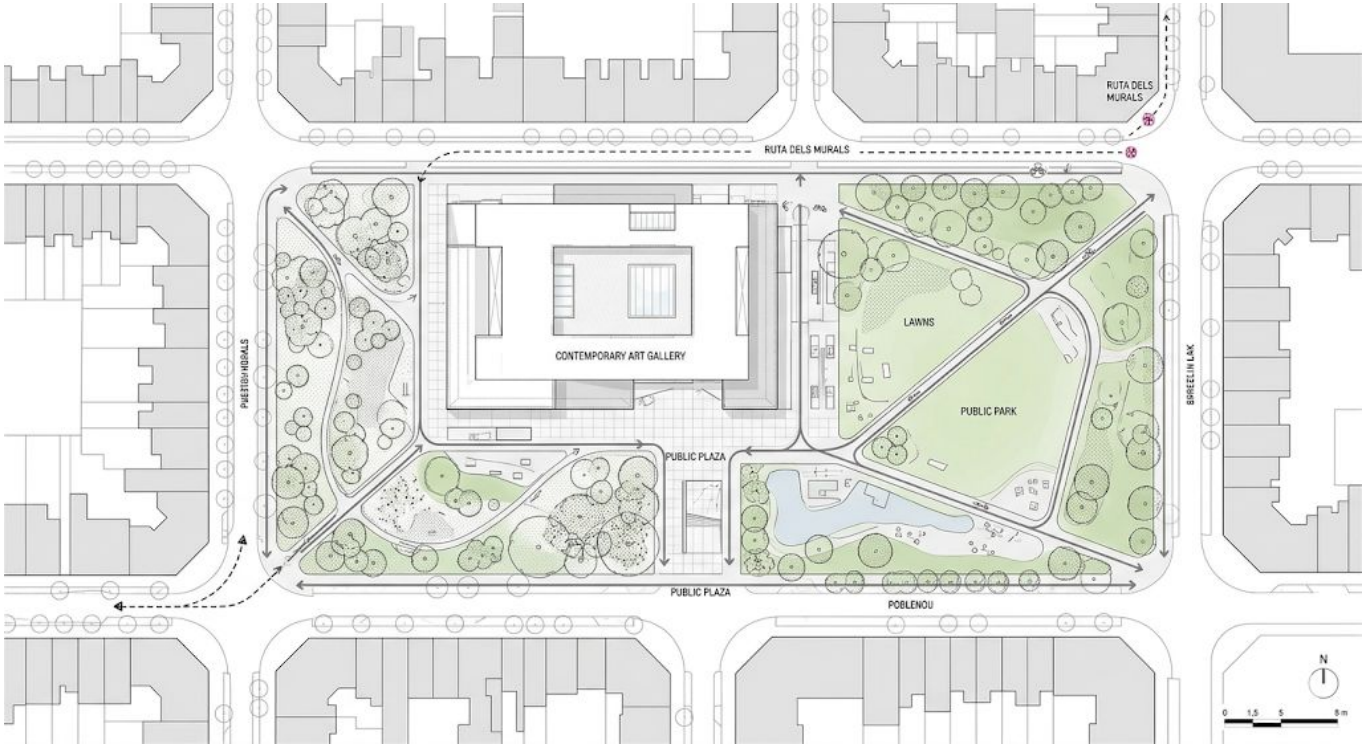
Small intimate gallery room inspired by MC Escher, focused lighting on artworks, atmospheric interior architecture, textured materials reflecting the artist’s themes, quiet contemplative space for visitors, minimalist museum design, cinematic architectural visualization.

INTERIOR RENDER – VIEW TO THE PARK



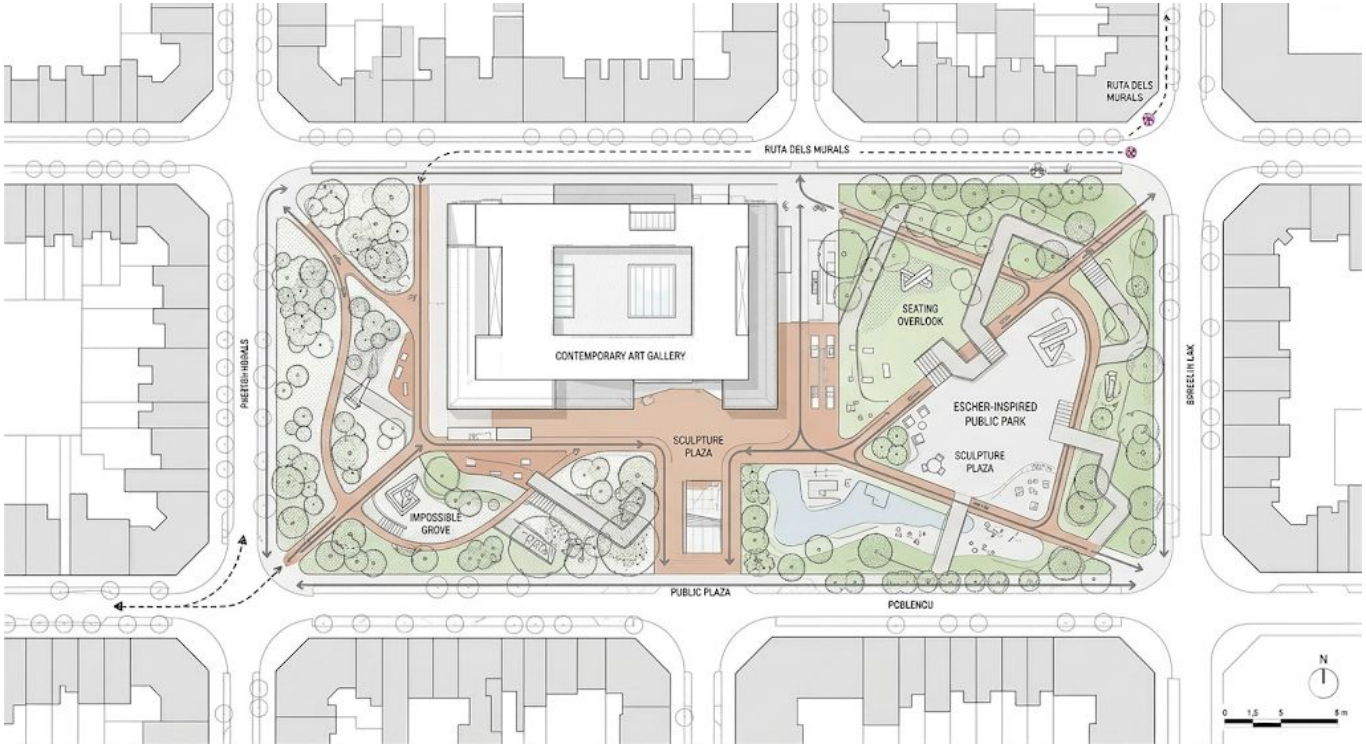
Museum interior gallery space opening to an outdoor sculpture garden and park, large glass walls framing Mediterranean landscape, connection between interior gallery and public park, architecture inspired by MC Escher, Barcelona sunlight entering the gallery, visitors walking between inside and outside spaces, cinematic architecture rendering.

SITE MASTERPLAN (TOP-DOWN)



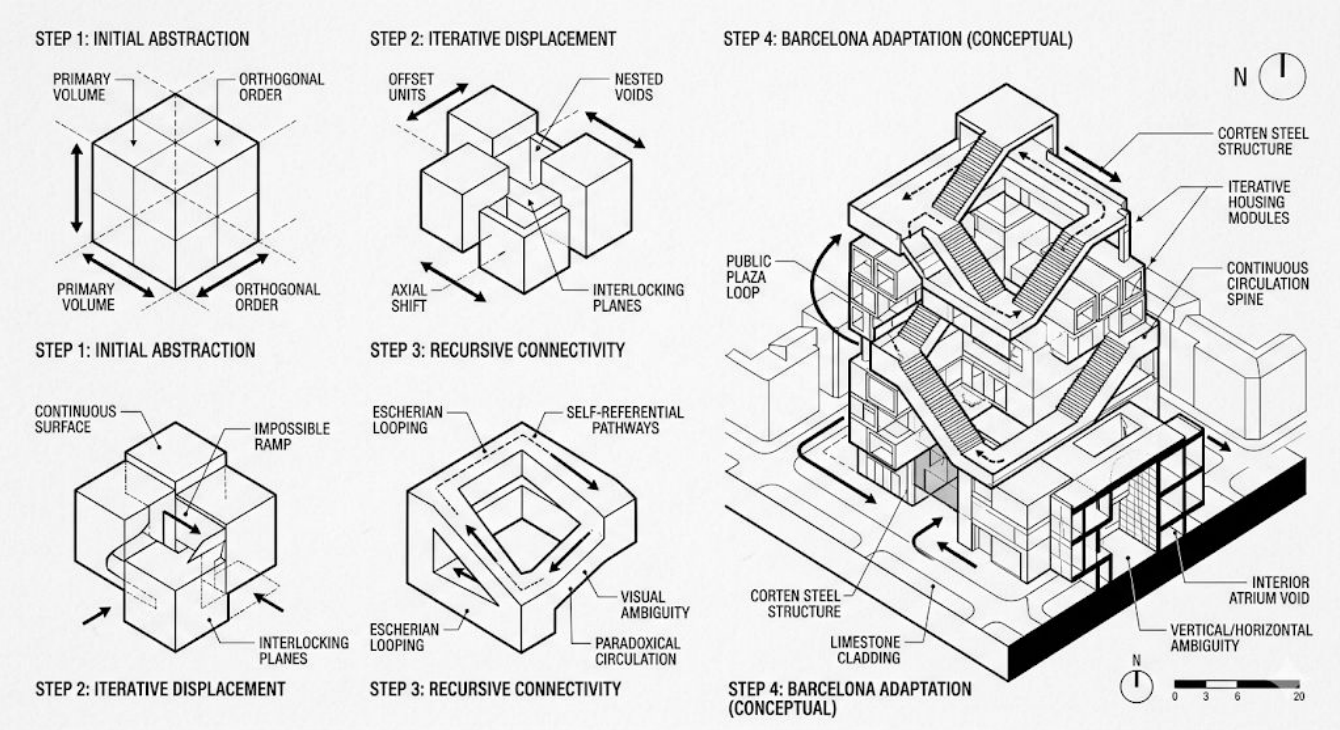
Architectural site master plan of contemporary art gallery and public park in Poblenou Barcelona near Ruta dels Murals, top down plan view, clear circulation paths, building footprint and surrounding park landscape, plazas, trees, pathways, urban blocks context, minimal architectural graphic style, white background with clean linework, professional architectural diagram.

PARK LANDSCAPE MASTERPLAN (MORE DETAILED)



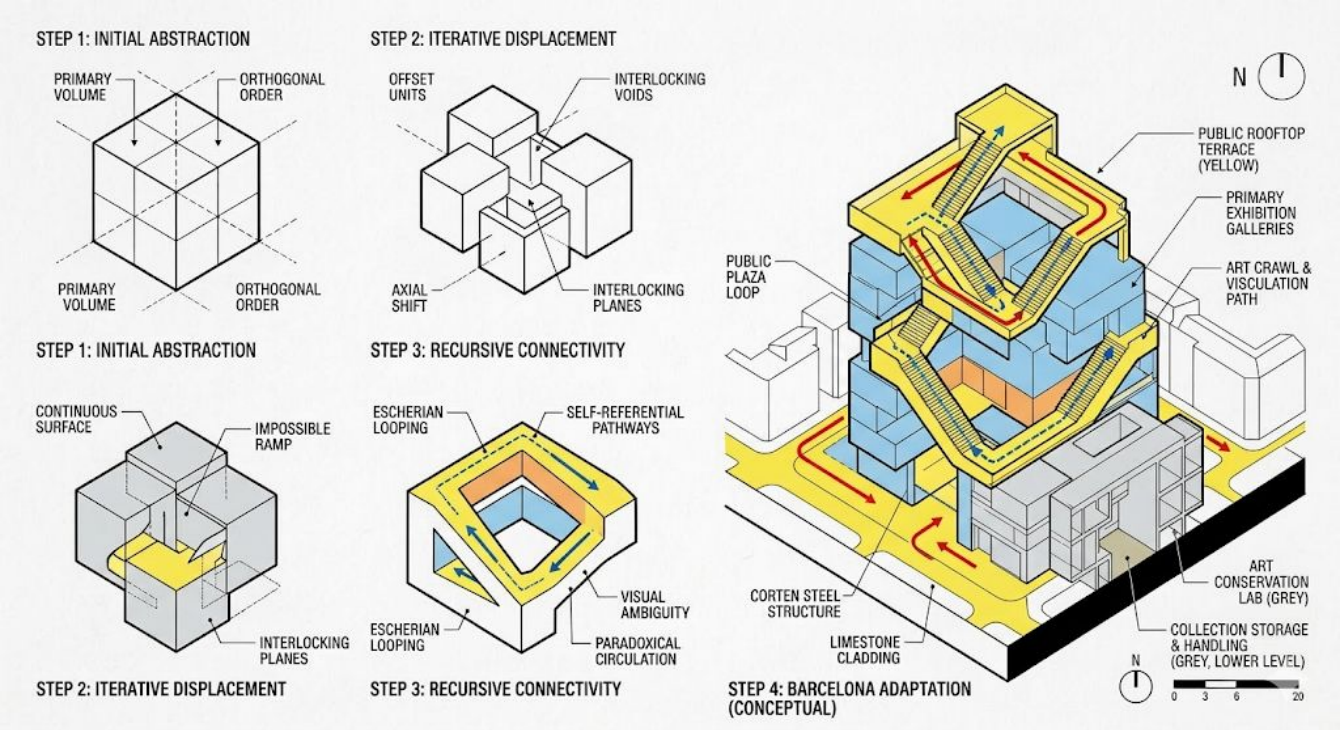
Landscape architecture masterplan of public park connected to contemporary art gallery inspired by MC Escher, pathways, plazas, sculpture garden areas, seating spaces, Mediterranean vegetation, clear circulation routes, minimal graphic architectural drawing style, top down plan view, professional architecture diagram aesthetic.

CONCEPT DIAGRAM



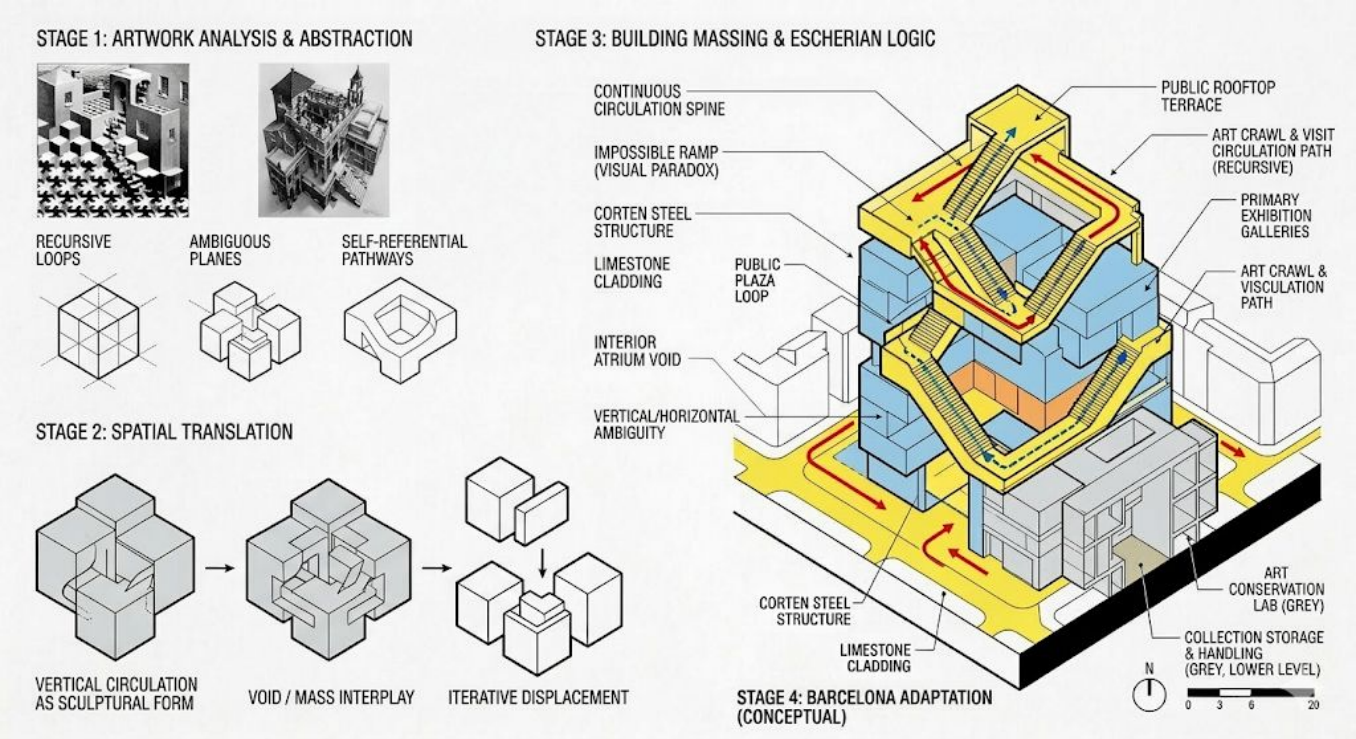
Architectural concept diagram explaining design idea inspired by MC Escher, simple abstract shapes showing idea development, minimal black and white architecture diagram style, arrows and annotations, conceptual architectural graphic.

SPATIAL ORGANIZATION DIAGRAM



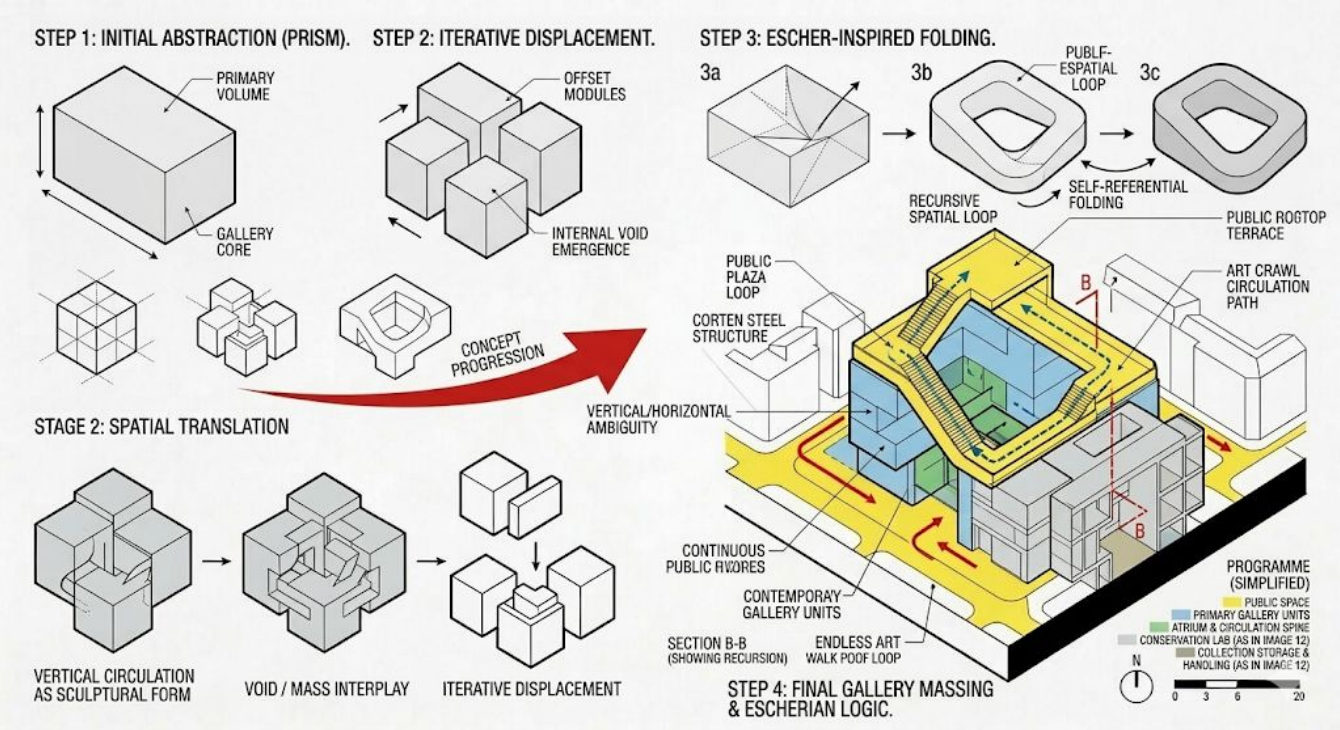
Architectural diagram showing spatial organization of art gallery, color coded program zones, circulation paths, public and private spaces, minimal architecture diagram style, white background, clean professional architectural graphic.

ARTIST to ARCHITECTURE DIAGRAM



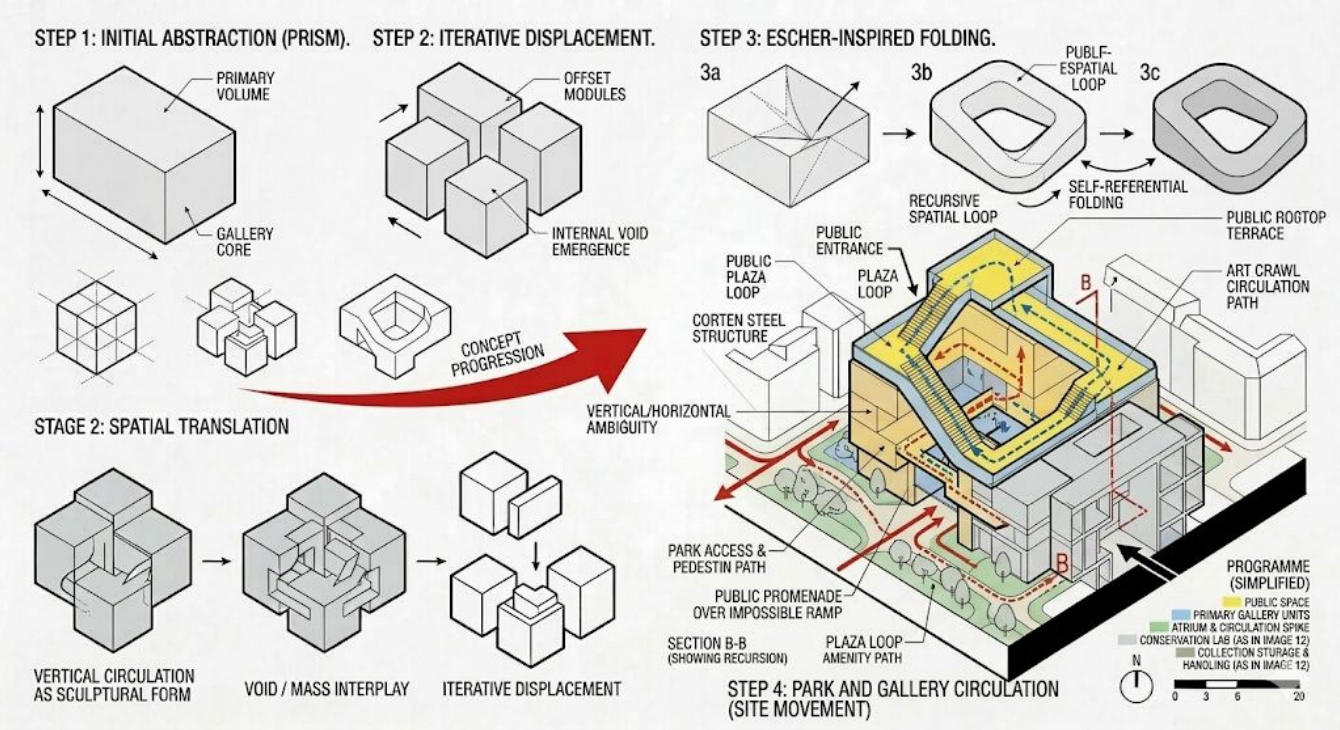
Architectural concept diagram showing translation from artwork of MC Escher into architectural form, artwork abstraction transforming into building massing and spatial design, minimal architecture diagram style, clear visual progression, professional architectural graphic.

MASSING DEVELOPMENT DIAGRAM



Step by step architectural massing development diagram for contemporary art gallery, simple block forms evolving into final building form inspired by MC Escher, minimal architectural graphic style, white background, arrows and step numbers.

CIRCULATION DIAGRAM



Architectural circulation diagram of gallery and park showing pedestrian movement through site, paths connecting park and building, minimal architecture diagram style, arrows and simplified forms, clean white background.

Exploded Axonometric



Exploded axonometric architectural diagram of contemporary art gallery inspired by MC Escher, building layers separated showing structure, galleries, circulation and roof, minimal architectural graphic style, clean white background. Architectural photography, shot on 24mm lens, high detail, professional architecture visualization.

AI Process

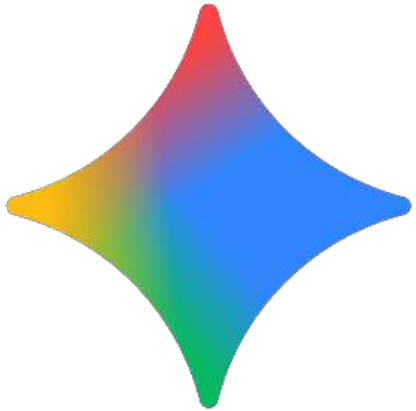
Lessons Learned

One thing I learned is how important it is to be very specific when writing prompts. Adding details about materials, lighting, or perspective helped the AI produce better images. It also usually took several iterations to get close to the result I wanted.

Wording also made a big difference. Small changes in phrasing could lead to very different outputs, so experimenting with prompts was necessary. The AI was helpful for generating new ideas and visualizing possibilities, but it often struggled with accuracy and didn't always match what I had in mind.

I also noticed that the AI sometimes repeated mistakes from earlier prompts. When that happened, starting a new chat usually helped reset the process and produce better results.





Prompting

ChatGPT:

I started with a simple description of the scene, like an exterior, interior, or site plan. Then I added details related to the artist's style, including materials, forms, and atmosphere.

From there, I adjusted the prompts based on the results. Small wording changes often produced very different images, so the process mostly involved experimenting and refining the prompts through multiple iterations.

Google Nano Banana:

What Works: My prompts clearly communicated the desired output by using specific technical terms like 'exploded axonometric diagram' and '24mm lens,' and incorporating 'MC Escher' as a creative direction effectively guides the AI.

What Could Be Improved: You could enhance your prompts by providing more specific guidance on the emotional tone and narrative, such as the mood you want the visualization to evoke or the story it should tell.

Thank You